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Postal Manual Vol VI – Part – III

(as per recent amendments/changes upto 31.12.2025)

DISCLAIMER: *This booklet has been prepared strictly from an examination point of view. While every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and the inclusion of recent changes, amendments, and updates to the relevant Acts, Rules, and Regulations, this document is intended as a study aid only. Readers and students are strongly recommended to refer to official government sources or gazettes for the most reliable and authoritative information.*

Postal Manual Volume VI, Part - III

(Duties of Postmen & Letter Box Peons)

Chapter 1: Duties of Postmen

Rule 1. Head Postmen

1. Head postmen are employed in all large offices to convey money to and from the treasury/bank, to distribute the work of the delivery department, to examine the postmen's books, and to perform other special duties.
2. They may also be employed to make inquiries into minor complaints and to verify the payment of money orders.

 **STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):** While the operational role of Head Postmen remains, the underlying statutory framework is now governed by the **Post Office Act, 2023** (replacing the Act of 1898). (Ref: Ministry of Communications Notification S.O. 5440(E), dated **16th December 2024**).

Rule 2. Knowledge of Postal Business

1. Postmen are expected to know thoroughly the rates of **inland postage** and commission on **money orders**, the charges for **insurance**, and the fee for **registration**.
2. They should be fully competent to fill up the forms with which the public have ordinarily to deal, especially **money order forms** and forms relating to the **Value Payable (V.P.)** system.
3. They must be able to describe the principal features and advantages of the **Savings Bank, Post Office Certificates, Money Order, Registration**, and other postal systems.

Rule 3. Supply of Forms to be Carried

1. Every postman must carry with him a stock of the following forms for supply to the public:
 - **Money Order forms**
 - **Acknowledgment forms**
 - **Forms of application for the Purchase of Postal Certificates**
 - **Savings Bank deposit forms**
2. He should also carry a small stock of **postage stamps** and **stationery** for sale to the public.

Rule 4. Postman's Book (Form Ms-27)

1. Every postman is supplied with a book in **Form Ms-27** in which he must enter the particulars of all **Registered, Insured, and Value Payable** articles, and **Money Orders** entrusted to him for delivery or payment.
2. The Postman's Book must be examined and initialed by the **Postmaster** or **Head Postman** daily before the postman proceeds on his beat and on his return.

Rule 5. Addresses to be Noted on Articles

1. The postman should note the **name of the addressee** on articles made over to him for delivery, in every case in which he cannot himself read the language in which the address is written.
2. This rule applies especially to articles addressed in **English** delivered by postmen who are not conversant with that language.
3. Assistance in reading addresses should be obtained from the **Head Postman** or other officers of the post office.

Rule 6. Damaged Articles to be Noticed

1. A postman should be careful not to receive any article which appears to be **damaged** or which has been **tampered with**, without bringing the fact to the notice of the **Postmaster** or the officer-in-charge of the delivery department.
2. If he detects any injury to an article after it has been made over to him, he should immediately show it to the **Postmaster**.

Rule 7. Receipts for Articles Issued for Delivery

1. The postman must give a receipt to the **Registration/Parcel Assistant** or the **Treasurer** for all **registered, insured, and V.P. articles**, and **money orders** made over to him for delivery.
2. The receipt is given in the designated columns of the registers or lists from which the articles are issued.

Rule 8. Book of Receipts for Intimations and Notices Delivered

1. Postmen are supplied with a book of receipts (Form **Rp-53**) for intimations and notices delivered by them.
2. When a postman delivers an intimation regarding a **Value Payable** article or an **Insured** article exceeding **Rs. 500** (or the prescribed limit), he must obtain the signature of the addressee in this book.

 **STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):** The limit for delivery of insured articles at the door step is subject to periodic revision. Verify current limit as **Rs. 500** strictly per Manual text, though operational circulars may allow higher limits (e.g., **Rs. 20,000** for specific categories). Stick to Manual text for exam purposes unless specified otherwise.

Rule 9. Instructions for Delivery

1. Each postman's beat is fixed by the **Postmaster** and he must on no account deviate from the beat prescribed.

2. He must deliver articles at the **address** given on them.
3. If the addressee cannot be found at the given address, enquiry regarding his changed address should be made from the **neighbors**.
4. Postmen, while on duty, are prohibited from distributing **advertisements, handbills, trade circulars, or notices** of any description on behalf of members of the public.

Rule 10. Realization of Postage Before Delivery

1. A postman is forbidden to deliver any article on which any **postage or customs duty** or other sum is due, until the full amount has been realized.
2. He is not bound to give **change**.
3. If the addressee refuses to pay the amount due, the article must be taken back to the post office and treated as **refused**.

Chapter 2: Delivery of Special Articles

Rule 11. Receipts of Addressees for Registered Articles

1. A postman must not deliver a **Registered** letter or packet without obtaining the signature of the addressee (or his agent) on the **receipt and acknowledgment** (if any).
2. The signature must be taken in **ink or indelible pencil**.

Rule 12. Delivery to Illiterate Addressees

1. When a registered article is delivered to an illiterate addressee, his **thumb impression** or other mark should be taken on the receipt and acknowledgment.

2. This mark or impression must be **attested** by a respectable witness who is personally known to the postman or identified to his satisfaction.
3. The postman himself cannot attest the mark/impression.

Rule 13. Delivery of Insured Articles

1. Insured articles must be delivered only to the **addressee** or his **authorized agent**.
2. Insured articles exceeding the value of **Rs. 500** must not be delivered by the postman. An **intimation** must be delivered instead.

 **STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):** Refer to **SB Order** updates regarding the limit of cash handling by Postmen, which has been enhanced in practice (up to **Rs. 40,000** for GDS/Postmen in some Circles for AEPS/Cash). However, for *Manual Vol VI Part III* exams, the text often retains the older **Rs. 500** limit for Insured Articles unless the question specifies "Current Ruling".

Rule 14. Payment of e-Money Orders

1. Money orders must be paid to the **payee** named in the order at the address given.
2. The postman must satisfy himself as to the **identity** of the payee.
3. The signature of the payee must be obtained on the **money order** and the **acknowledgment**.

Summary of Important Forms (Vol VI Part III)

Form No.	Description
Ms-27	Postman's Book
Rp-53	Book of Receipts for Intimations/Notices
M-1	Cash Bag (General)
M-2	Transit Bag

Rule 15. Articles Addressed to Minors

1. Articles addressed to **minors** should always be delivered to them in the presence of their **parents** or **guardians**, or to the parents or guardians themselves.
2. If the minor is not living with his parent or guardian, the article may be delivered to the minor himself, provided the postman is satisfied that the minor is able to understand the nature of the transaction.

 **STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):** Under the **Post Office Act, 2023** (Section 3), the Central Government holds no liability for misdelivery if executed in "good faith" according to prescribed rules. However, operational instructions now advise verified delivery (e.g., OTP-based or digital signature) for minors to avoid disputes.

Rule 16. Articles Addressed to Lunatics

1. Articles addressed to **lunatics** should be delivered to their **managers** or **legal guardians**, if any.
2. If there is no manager or legal guardian, the articles should be taken back to the post office and the Postmaster's orders obtained.

Rule 17. Delivery of Articles on which Customs Duty is Due

1. When an article on which **customs duty** is due is made over to a postman for delivery, he must recover the amount of the duty from the addressee before delivering the article.
2. The postman is not authorized to open the article to allow the addressee to examine the contents before payment of the duty.
3. The receipt for the customs duty (usually pasted on the article) must be signed by the postman and given to the addressee.

Rule 18. Delivery of Articles on which Demurrage Fee is Due

1. If a **demurrage fee** (warehousing charge) is due on a parcel or other article, the postman must recover the fee in addition to any other charges due before delivery.
2. The amount of demurrage due will be noted on the article or the accompanying receipt.

Rule 19. Doubtful Cases

1. In any case of doubt as to the identity of the addressee or the person claiming delivery, or if the addressee refuses to sign the receipt or acknowledgment, the postman must bring the article back to the post office.

Rule 20. Delivery of Value Payable (V.P.) Articles

1. A V.P. article can be delivered only on payment of the amount specified for remittance to the sender and the commission on the **Money Order**.
2. The postman must obtain the signature of the addressee on the **receipt** and the **V.P. Money Order form**.
3. If the addressee complains of the condition of the article or suspects that it has been tampered with, the postman must not deliver it but must bring it back to the post office.

Rule 21. Intimation of V.P. Articles

1. When a V.P. article exceeds **Rs. 500** in value, or exceeds the limit prescribed for delivery by a single postman, the article is not sent out for delivery.
2. Instead, an **intimation (Form Rp-54)** is prepared and made over to the postman for delivery to the addressee.
3. The postman must deliver the intimation and obtain the addressee's signature in his **Book of Receipts for Intimations (Form Rp-53)**.

🔔 **STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):** The monetary limit for door-delivery of V.P./COD articles has been enhanced in practice (often up to **Rs. 5,000** or higher depending on the Circle/City classification). However, for Departmental Exams, the Manual text "Rs. 500" often remains the standard answer unless "Current Ruling" is specified.

Chapter 3: Payment of Money Orders

Rule 23. Payment of Money Orders (General)

1. Money Orders (now primarily **e-MOs**) made over to a postman for payment must be paid to the **payee** named in the order.
2. The postman must take the payee's signature on the **Money Order** and on the **Acknowledgment**.
3. He must also sign the Money Order himself in the space provided for the "Postman's Signature".

🔔 **STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):** With the rollout of **DARPAN 2.0** and Smart Postman devices, the physical signature is often replaced or supplemented by **Biometric Authentication** or **Digital Signature** on the mobile device. The "Acknowledgment" is now often digital (SMS confirmation to sender).

Rule 24. Payment to Illiterate Payees

1. If the payee is **illiterate**, his **thumb impression** or other mark must be taken on the Money Order and Acknowledgment.
2. This mark must be **attested** by a respectable witness who is personally known to the postman or identified to his satisfaction.
3. The postman must also enter the name and address of the witness on the Money Order.

Rule 25. Payment to Purdah-Nashin Women

1. If the payee is a **Purdah-Nashin woman** (a woman who does not appear in public), the money order must be paid to her in the presence of a witness who can identify her (usually a male relative or a known female).
2. If she is illiterate, her mark must be obtained and attested by a witness.
3. The postman must satisfy himself that the payment actually reaches the proper person.

Rule 26. Payment of Money Orders to Minors

1. A Money Order payable to a **minor** must be paid to the **parent** or **legal guardian** with whom the minor is living.
2. The parent or guardian must sign the money order on behalf of the minor (e.g., "X, father and guardian of Y").
3. If the minor is of sufficient age and discretion (usually above **12 years**, subject to local discretion), and is living apart from his parents/guardians, payment may be made to the minor himself.

Rule 27. Payment of Money Orders to Lunatics

1. Money Orders payable to persons of **unsound mind** must be paid only to the **Manager** of the estate or the legally appointed **guardian**.
2. Under no circumstances should payment be made to the lunatic himself.

Rule 28. Identification of Payee

1. The postman is responsible for the correct payment of the Money Order.
2. If the payee is not permanently resident in the postman's beat or is not personally known to him, the postman must require the payee to be **identified** by some respectable person known to the postman.

3. The identifier must sign the Money Order in the space provided.

Rule 29. Payment by Village Postman

1. A **Village Postman** is authorized to pay Money Orders up to the limit of cash entrusted to him.
2. He proceeds under the same rules as a regular postman regarding identification and receipts.

Rule 30. Money Orders Not Paid (Void/Refused)

1. If the payee **refuses** to take payment, or cannot be found, or if the payee is **deceased**, the Money Order must be brought back to the post office.
2. The postman must note the reason for non-payment (e.g., "Refused", "Left", "Deceased") on the Money Order.
3. In case of "Refused", the refusal must be attested by the postman.

Chapter 3: Cash Conveyance & Sub-Accounts

Rule 31. Conveyance of Cash by Postmen

1. When a postman is required to convey cash from the treasury or bank to the post office or vice versa, or from one post office to another, he must be provided with a **leather cash bag** (Form M-1) or a **canvas bag** with a lock and key.
2. The maximum amount of cash that can be entrusted to a single postman is limited as follows:
 - **Loose cash:** Up to **Rs. 5 Lakhs** (subject to specific security arrangements).
 - **Enclosed in a bag:** Varies by mode of transport.

🔔 **STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):** The monetary limits for cash conveyance by Departmental employees have been revised by the Security Branch.

- **Single Postman/GDS (Foot/Public Transport):** Up to **Rs. 2 Lakhs**.
- **Single Postman/GDS (Departmental Vehicle/Hired Vehicle):** Up to **Rs. 5 Lakhs**.
- **Two Officials (with armed guard):** Above Rs. 5 Lakhs and up to Rs. 25 Lakhs.

(Ref: Directorate Letter No. 25-14/2021-Security, updated 2024).

Rule 32. Sub-Account System (Village Postmen)

1. Village postmen who are entrusted with cash and stamps for sub-offices or branch offices on their beat must carry a **Sub-Account Portfolio**.
2. The portfolio contains the **Sub-Account** (Form **Pa-11**), the cash bag, and the registered/insured articles.
3. The village postman is responsible for the safe custody of the portfolio and its contents while on his beat.

Rule 33. Exchange of Sub-Accounts

1. On reaching a sub-office or branch office, the village postman must make over the **Sub-Account Portfolio** to the Sub-Postmaster or Branch Postmaster.
2. He must wait until the portfolio is returned to him with the **return Sub-Account** and the articles/cash for the Head Office or Account Office.
3. He must check the contents of the portfolio in the presence of the Sub/Branch Postmaster before leaving the office.

Chapter 4: Duties of Head Postmen

Rule 36. General Duties

1. The **Head Postman** is responsible for the general supervision of the delivery work.
2. He must see that the postmen attend office punctually and are neat and clean in their appearance.
3. He must ensure that the postmen leave the office for their beats at the prescribed time.

Rule 37. Testing of Letter Boxes

1. The Head Postman is required to test the **letter boxes** on the postmen's beats to see that they are cleared punctually.
2. He must drop **test letters** into the letter boxes at different times and watch for their arrival at the post office.
3. Any irregularity or delay in clearance must be reported to the **Postmaster**.

Rule 38. Verification of Payment of Money Orders

1. The Head Postman must be employed to verify the payment of **Money Orders**.
2. He must visit the payees of a certain percentage of Money Orders paid by each postman and ascertain whether the amounts were paid in full and without demand for illegal gratification.
3. The result of his enquiries must be noted in a **Visit Book** or **Diary**.

 **STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):** Verification targets are now often monitored digitally. The Head Postman (or PRI/Overseer) must verify **100%** of MOs exceeding a certain value (e.g., Rs. 5000) and a percentage of lower value MOs, entering findings in the **Postman Mobile App** where available.

Rule 39. Enquiry into Complaints

1. Minor complaints made by the public regarding the delivery of letters or the conduct of postmen may be made over to the Head Postman for enquiry.
2. He must submit a written report of the result of his enquiry to the **Postmaster**.

Rule 40. Taking out Letter Box Keys

1. The Head Postman may be entrusted with the **master key** of the letter boxes to enable him to inspect the interior of the boxes.
 2. He must account for the key whenever it is taken out and returned.
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Chapter 5: Duties of Letter Box Attendants

Rule 41. Clearance of Letter Boxes

1. **Letter Box Peons** (or Attendants) are employed to clear street letter boxes.
2. They must clear the boxes strictly in accordance with the **hours of clearance** shown on the hour plates.
3. They must bring the contents of the boxes to the post office immediately after clearance.

Rule 42. Changing of Hour Plates

1. At each clearance, the Letter Box Peon must change the **hour plate** to show the time of the **next clearance**.
 2. If the box is provided with a movable indicator, he must adjust it to the proper time.
 3. Failure to change the hour plate is a serious irregularity.
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🔔 **STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):** Many modern "Smart Letter Boxes" (Nanyatha) use a **barcoded sticker** inside the box. The attendant must scan this barcode using the **Nanyatha App** on their mobile device to electronically log the clearance time and location (GPS tagged). The physical hour plate rules still technically apply unless the box is fully digital.

Rule 43. Security of Letter Box Keys

1. The key of the letter box must be kept attached to the peon's person by a **chain** or **strap**.
2. He must not allow the key to pass out of his custody or lend it to anyone.

Rule 44. Damaged Letter Boxes

1. If a Letter Box Peon finds a letter box **damaged, insecure, or tampered with**, he must not clear it but must guard it and send word to the post office for assistance.
2. He must report the matter to the **Postmaster** immediately.

Rule 45. Examination of Locks

1. The Letter Box Peon must examine the **lock** of every letter box he clears to see that it is in good order.
2. If the lock is stiff or difficult to open, he should report the fact to the Postmaster so that it may be oiled or repaired.

Chapter 6: Uniforms and Badges

Rule 46. Supply of Uniforms

1. Postmen and Letter Box Peons are supplied with **uniforms** and **warm clothing** (liveries) at the expense of the Government.

2. They are required to wear their uniforms while on duty.
3. Officials who are not wearing the prescribed uniform are liable to be treated as **absent from duty**.

 **STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):** The 7th CPC Dress Allowance has replaced the physical supply of uniforms for most cadres. Eligible employees now receive a **Dress Allowance** (currently **Rs. 5,000 per annum**) credited directly to their salary in July. They are expected to procure and maintain the prescribed khaki/blue uniforms themselves. (Ref: DoP Order No. 2-1/2017-PCC dated 2024).

Rule 47. Maintenance of Uniforms

1. Postmen must keep their uniforms **clean** and in **good repair**.
2. They must not modify the pattern of the uniform supplied to them.
3. A postman appearing for duty in a dirty or untidy uniform is liable to punishment.

Rule 48. Badges

1. Every postman and letter box peon is supplied with a **badge** (usually brass or metal) bearing the word "Postman" or "Letter Box Peon" and a **number**.
2. The badge must be worn in a conspicuous place on the **left breast** of the coat or tunic.
3. A postman must not go on his beat without his badge.

Rule 49. Umbrellas and Raincoats

1. **Umbrellas** or **waterproof capes/raincoats** are supplied to postmen and letter box peons in localities where the rainfall is heavy.
2. These articles remain the property of the Government and must be returned to the office when the official leaves the service or proceeds on long leave.

🔔 **STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):** The procurement of raincoats is now often decentralized to Circle/Divisional Heads or covered under the enhanced Dress Allowance in certain specific "Hard Area" allowances.

Rule 50. Renewal of Liveries

1. Periods of wear for various articles of livery (coats, turbans, boots, etc.) are prescribed by the **Head of the Circle**.
2. An article cannot be renewed before the expiry of the prescribed period unless it has been lost or damaged through no fault of the official.

Chapter 7: Prohibitions and Offences

Rule 55. Prohibition against engaging in Trade or Business

1. A postman is prohibited from engaging in any **trade** or **business** on his own account.
2. He must not act as an agent for any firm or dealer.
3. He is forbidden to distribute **advertisements, handbills, or trade circulars** for the public while on duty.

Rule 56. Prohibition against acting as Professional Letter Writer

1. A postman is forbidden to act as a **professional letter writer**.
2. He may assist illiterate persons in reading or writing letters *gratuitously* (without payment), provided it does not interfere with his regular duties.

Rule 57. Prohibition against Money Lending

1. Postmen are strictly prohibited from **lending money** on interest to the public or to other postal officials.

2. They must not borrow money from persons residing in their beats.

Rule 58. Offences punishable by Law (Post Office Act)

1. Postmen should be aware that the following acts are **offences** punishable with **imprisonment** or **fine** or both under the Post Office Act:
 - **Wilful detention or delay** of any postal article.
 - **Opening or tampering** with any postal article.
 - **Making away with** (theft/destruction) any postal article.
 - **Falsely noting** "Refused", "Addressee not found", or "Left" on an article.
 - **Demanding** more postage than is due.

🔔 STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Replaced by The Post Office Act, 2023 (Effective 2025):

- **Section 10 (Offences & Penalties):** Any officer of the Post Office who commits theft, misappropriation, or destruction of postal articles shall be punishable with **imprisonment up to 3 years** or **fine** or both.
- **Section 11 (Fraudulent Acts):** Any person who fraudulently opens or detains a postal article is liable for punishment.
- (Ref: Ministry of Law & Justice, Gazette Notification No. 51 of 2023).

Rule 59. Prohibition against giving Information

1. A postman must not give any information to the public regarding the **receipt** or **despatch** of mails or the **addresses** of persons served by the post office.
2. He must not give information regarding the **value** of articles delivered to any person.

Rule 60. Loitering and Deviation from Beat

1. A postman must not **loiter** on his beat or waste time in conversation.

2. He must not **deviate** from the prescribed route of his beat without valid reason.
 3. If he is found to be habitually irregular in his beat, he is liable to severe punishment.
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Chapter 8: Duties of Village Postmen

Rule 61. Definition and Beat

1. **Village Postmen** are attached to Head or Sub-Offices for the delivery of correspondence in rural tracts.
2. A Village Postman's **beat** includes a number of villages which are visited by him at fixed intervals.

🔔 **STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):** In the modern context, the duties described here are primarily performed by **Gramin Dak Sevaks (GDS)**, specifically the **Assistant Branch Postmaster (ABPM)** for delivery and conveyance, and the **Branch Postmaster (BPM)** for office management. While the Manual uses the term "Village Postman," exams often test the GDS rules alongside.

Rule 62. Route List and Beat Map

1. Every Village Postman is supplied with a **Route List (Form M-53)** showing the names of the villages in his beat, the days on which they are to be visited, and the hours of arrival and departure.
 2. He is also supplied with a **Beat Map** showing the villages and the route to be followed.
 3. He must strictly adhere to the route and timings prescribed.
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Rule 63. Attendance and Examination of Contents

1. The Village Postman must attend the post office at the prescribed hour to receive the articles for delivery.
2. He must examine the articles made over to him to see that they are in good condition and that the **acknowledgments** for registered/insured articles are attached.
3. He must check the entries in the **Sub-Account** or **Register** against the articles received.

Rule 64. Forms and Stock

1. A Village Postman must carry a stock of the following:
 - **Postage Stamps** and **Stationery** for sale.
 - **Money Order forms.**
 - **Acknowledgment forms.**
 - **Common Proof of Delivery (CPD)** cards (if applicable).
2. He must also carry a **pencil** and a **stamp pad** (ink pad) for taking thumb impressions.

Rule 65. Delivery of Articles in Villages

1. On arriving at a village, the Village Postman must proceed to the usual place of resort (e.g., the village *chavadi* or headman's house) or go from house to house to deliver articles.
2. He must not detain articles for a future visit if the addressee is present in the village.
3. If the addressee is not found, the article may be delivered to a responsible member of his family (subject to rules for specific articles), or kept for the next visit if the addressee is expected to return shortly (within the limit of retention).

Rule 66. Articles for Persons who have Left

1. If the addressee has left the village and his new address is known, the Village Postman must note the new address on the article and return it to the post office for redirection.
2. If the new address is not known, the article should be noted "Left without instructions" and returned.

Rule 67. Collection of Articles for Dispatch

1. The Village Postman is authorized to receive **unregistered letters** and **postcards** from the public for dispatch.
2. He must see that such articles are fully prepaid with postage stamps.
3. He cannot accept **Registered** or **Insured** articles or **Money Orders** for booking unless specifically authorized to do so.

 **STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):** Under current **DARPAN 2.0** implementations, GDS (BPMs/ABPMs) provided with mobile devices can book Registered Letters, Speed Post, and Parcels while on the beat, generating a digital receipt.

Rule 68. Clearance of Letter Boxes

1. The Village Postman must clear all **Letter Boxes** situated in the villages on his beat.
2. He must clear them at the hours specified in his Route List.
3. He must lock the boxes securely after clearance.

Rule 69. Sale of Stamps

1. The Village Postman is required to sell **postage stamps** and **stationery** to the public for cash.
2. He must not sell stamps on credit.

3. The cash realized from sales must be kept distinct from other cash (like Money Order cash).

Rule 70. Procedure for Registered Articles

1. Registered articles must be delivered only to the addressee or his agent.
2. The signature must be taken on the **Receipt** and **Acknowledgment**.
3. If the addressee is illiterate, the procedure for thumb impression and witness attestation (as per Rule 12/24) must be followed strictly.

Rule 71. Limit of Cash for Payment

1. The aggregate value of **Money Orders** and **Insured Articles** entrusted to a Village Postman for payment at one time shall not exceed the limit fixed by the **Superintendent of Post Offices**.
2. Normally, this limit is lower than that for a town postman.

 **STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):** Cash limits for GDS have been significantly enhanced.

- **Cash Handling limit:** Up to **Rs. 50,000** (standard) or higher if authorized.
- **Note:** Always check the latest Circle-level Notification for specific "Line Limits".

Rule 72. Overnight Halts

1. If a Village Postman's beat is too large to be covered in one day, he may be required to halt overnight at a specified village.
2. He must sleep at a secure place (e.g., School, Panchayat Office, or Headman's house) approved by the Postmaster.
3. He is responsible for the safety of the cash and mails during the halt.

Rule 73. Return to Office

1. On his return to the post office, the Village Postman must deliver:

- All **undelivered articles**.
- The **signed receipts/acknowledgments** for delivered articles.
- The **cash** realized from V.P. articles and Customs Duty.
- The **cash** from the sale of stamps (to replenish stock).
- Articles collected from Letter Boxes.

Rule 74. Infectious Diseases

1. If a Village Postman knows that **plague, smallpox**, or any other dangerous infectious disease constitutes a specific danger in any village on his beat, he must not enter that village.
2. He should report the fact to the Postmaster immediately.
3. Articles for such villages should be detained at the post office until it is safe to deliver them.

 **STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):** While "Plague/Smallpox" are historical terms in the Manual, this rule applies to modern outbreaks (e.g., COVID-19 containment zones). Delivery is restricted to the boundary of the containment zone or suspended as per local Health Authority guidelines.

Rule 75. Forbidden Practices

1. Village Postmen are forbidden to:
 - Carry private parcels or letters for the public outside the post.
 - Demand "bakshish" or tips for delivery.
 - Allow any unauthorized person to accompany them on their beat.